

Snowflake CLI (snow) — Developer Cheatsheet

The snow CLI for Snowflake: deploy apps, run SQL, manage objects, and call Cortex AI — all from your terminal or CI/CD pipeline.

[!IMPORTANT] Community cheatsheet — not official Snowflake documentation. For the authoritative reference, see [Snowflake CLI docs](#).

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Install & Update

# run in terminal	
pip install snowflake-cli	# pip (recommended)
pipx install snowflake-cli	# pipx (isolated)
brew install snowflake-cli	# macOS Homebrew
snow --version	# verify install
snow update	# update to latest
snow update 3.18.0	# pin to specific
version	

Quick Start By Role

If you are a...	Focus on
Data Engineer / Analyst	snow sql, snow object, snow stage
App Developer (Streamlit, Native Apps)	snow streamlit, snow app
ML / AI Engineer	snow cortex, snow snowpark
Platform / DevOps	snow connection, snow dcm, snow spcs

Connection

Connections are defined in ~/.snowflake/connections.toml (or \$SNOWFLAKE_HOME/connections.toml).

```
# run in terminal
snow connection add                                # interactive wizard
snow connection add \
  --connection-name myconn \
  --account orgname-accountname \
  --user myuser \
  --authenticator OAUTH_AUTHORIZATION_CODE \      # recommended (see
snowflake-gh-authn-cheatsheet)
  --client-store-temporary-credential true

snow connection list                                # list all
connections

snow connection set-default myconn                  # set active default
snow connection test -c myconn                      # test a named
connection
snow connection test -x                             # test via env vars
(no config needed)

# Generate a workload identity token (for CI/CD OIDC flows)
snow connection generate-workload-identity-token --workload-
identity-provider OIDC
```

[!TIP] -c selects a named connection; -x (--temporary-connection) builds the connection from environment variables instead of connections.toml — ideal for CI/CD.

Cortex AI (snow cortex)

[!NOTE] Available models vary by region. Check the [supported models list](#) for your account. Commonly available: claude-3-5-sonnet, llama3.1-70b, mistral-large2, snowflake-arctic. Use --model to specify; default is account-level.

Ask a question or run a prompt:

```
# run in terminal
snow cortex complete "Summarize the benefits of Snowflake
clustering"
snow cortex complete "Summarize the benefits of Snowflake
clustering" \
  --model claude-3-5-sonnet
```

```
# Multi-turn conversation from a JSON file
snow cortex complete --file samples/complete_datacloud.json
```

Extract an answer from a text passage:

```
snow cortex extract-answer \
  "What is the capital of France?" \
  "France is a country in Western Europe. Its capital city is
Paris."
```

Text analysis shortcuts:

```
snow cortex sentiment samples/sentiment.txt          # sentiment
score (-1 to 1)
snow cortex summarize samples/summarize.txt          # summarize a
document
snow cortex translate samples/translate.txt \
  --source-language French \
  --target-language English
```

SQL (snow sql)

```
# run in terminal
snow sql -q "SELECT current_version()"              # inline query
snow sql -f my_script.sql                           # run a file
cat my_script.sql | snow sql --stdin                # pipe from
stdin
snow sql -f script.sql -c prod                      # use a
specific connection

# Variable substitution (STANDARD syntax – recommended)
snow sql -q "GRANT USAGE ON DATABASE <% db %> TO ROLE <% role %>"
\
  -D "db=mydb" -D "role=analyst"
```

```
# Access environment variables (requires snowflake.yml env section
or --env)
snow sql -q "GRANT ROLE admin TO USER <% ctx.env.SNOWFLAKE_USER
%>" \
  --env SNOWFLAKE_USER=$SNOWFLAKE_USER

# Restrict to local files only (safe for untrusted SQL in CI)
snow sql -f script.sql --local-only

# Multiple files sequentially
snow sql -f setup.sql -f data.sql -f verify.sql

# Execute asynchronously (returns query ID immediately)
snow sql -q "INSERT INTO big_table SELECT * FROM source;"
```

Objects (snow object)

Manage most Snowflake objects via snow object:

```
# run in terminal
snow object create warehouse mywh \
  '{"warehouse_size": "X-SMALL", "auto_suspend": 300}'

snow object list warehouse                # list
warehouses
snow object list table --like 'orders%' \
  --database mydb --schema public        # filter by
name pattern
snow object list schema --in database mydb

snow object describe warehouse mywh      # full details
snow object drop table mydb.public.old_table # drop an object
```

Supported types: warehouse, database, schema, table, view, function, procedure, role, user, stage, task, stream, pipe, and more. Run snow object --help for the full list.

Stages (snow stage)

```
# run in terminal
snow stage create mydb.public.my_stage    # create a stage

# Upload files
snow stage copy ./data/ @mydb.public.my_stage/data/      #
local → stage
snow stage copy @mydb.public.my_stage/data/ ./local_copy/ #
stage → local

snow stage list @mydb.public.my_stage      # list files
```

```

snow stage list @mydb.public.my_stage --like '*.sql' # filter

# Execute SQL files directly from a stage
snow stage execute @mydb.public.my_stage/migration.sql

# Remove files
snow stage remove @mydb.public.my_stage/old_data.csv
snow stage remove @mydb.public.my_stage/archive/      # remove a
directory

```

Streamlit (snow streamlit)

```

# run in terminal – from project directory containing
snowflake.yml
snow streamlit deploy                                # deploy to
Snowflake
snow streamlit deploy --replace                       # replace
existing app

snow streamlit list                                  # list all
apps
snow streamlit describe my_app                       # app details
snow streamlit get-url my_app                        # open URL in
browser

# Stream live logs (SPCSv2 container runtime only; new in 3.18.0)
snow streamlit logs my_app --tail 100                # last 100
lines
snow streamlit logs my_app --tail 0 --follow          # follow live

snow streamlit drop my_app                            # remove app

```

Minimal snowflake.yml for Streamlit:

```

definition_version: 2
entities:
  my_app:
    type: streamlit
    identifier: my_app
    stage: my_stage
    main_file: app.py
    query_warehouse: compute_wh

```

Apps (snow app)

Supports both **Snowflake Native Apps** (application/application package entity types) and **Snowflake Apps Deploy** (snowflake-app entity type). The entity type in snowflake.yml determines which flow is used automatically.

# run in terminal	
snow app init my_native_app	# scaffold a
Native App project	
snow app setup	# init
snowflake.yml for App Deploy (new in 3.17.0)	
snow app bundle	# bundle
artifacts locally	
snow app deploy	# deploy to
Snowflake (create or update)	
snow app deploy --no-prune	# deploy
without removing extra files	
snow app validate	# validate app
before deploying	
snow app run	# deploy + open
in browser	
snow app open	# open existing
app in browser	
snow app events	# view app
event logs	
snow app version create v1_0 --patch 0	# create a
release version	
snow app version drop v1_0	# drop a version
snow app teardown	# remove all
app objects	
snow app teardown --force	# skip
confirmation	

Minimal snowflake.yml for Native App:

```
definition_version: 2
entities:
  my_pkg:
    type: application package
    stage: app_stage
    manifest: manifest.yml
  my_app:
    type: application
    from:
      target: my_pkg
```

Environment Variables

Override any connection parameter without modifying `connections.toml`:

Variable	What it sets
SNOWFLAKE_ACCOUNT	Account identifier
SNOWFLAKE_USER	Username
SNOWFLAKE_PASSWORD	Password or PAT
SNOWFLAKE_AUTHENTICATOR	Auth method (e.g. OAUTH_AUTHORIZATION_CODE)
SNOWFLAKE_PRIVATE_KEY_RAW	Raw private key for key-pair auth
SNOWFLAKE_DEFAULT_CONNECTION_NAME	Override the default connection
SNOWFLAKE_HOME	Override config directory (default <code>~/.snowflake</code>)
SNOWFLAKE_CONNECTIONS_<NAME>_<PARAM>	Override one param of a named connection
SNOWFLAKE_ENHANCED_EXIT_CODES	1 for differentiated exit codes (2=bad params, 5=query error)

Per-connection override example — override just the role for a named connection `myconn`:

```
# run in terminal
SNOWFLAKE_CONNECTIONS_MYCONN_ROLE=analyst snow sql -q "SELECT
current_role()"
```

Tips & Gotchas

- **-x is the CI pattern.** `snow connection test -x` and `snow sql -f script.sql -x` use environment variables (`SNOWFLAKE_ACCOUNT`, `SNOWFLAKE_USER`, etc.) instead of `connections.toml` — no config file needed on runners. Pair with OIDC for secretless CI.
- **<% var %> is the recommended template syntax.** The legacy `&variable_name` still works but is deprecated. Use `<% ctx.env.VAR %>` to read from environment variables passed with `--env VAR=value`, not `&{ctx.env.VAR}` (mixed syntax that does not work).
- **--local-only for trusted SQL enforcement.** Added in 3.19.0: prevents `!source` and `!load` from fetching URLs, so SQL files cannot pull in remote content. Use in CI when you want to guarantee no outbound requests from SQL execution.
- **snow app entity type is automatic.** Since 3.17.0, the same `snow app deploy` command works for both Native Apps and

Snowflake Apps Deploy — the `type:` field in `snowflake.yml` selects the behavior. No separate command groups needed.

- **Private key passphrase lookups changed in 3.17.1.** The passphrase is now read from `private_key_file_pwd` or `private_key_passphrase` in config. The `PRIVATE_KEY_PASSPHRASE` env var still takes precedence when set.

References

- [Snowflake CLI documentation](#)
- [CLI command reference](#)
- [snow sql — executing SQL](#)
- [Snowflake CLI 2026 release notes](#)
- [Cortex LLM supported models](#)